On what basis FieldNote recommends.

A recommendation is only worth trusting if you can see how it was reached. Every card is scored on four axes, then mapped to an action by a fixed rule. Nothing rests on opinion or a vendor's press release.

1 · Evidence grade — how well substantiated

A	Independent production evidence — named organisation, method, measurable result. Language: "observed in production".
B	Named customer case study or credible research with clear methodology. Language: "reported / associated with".
C	Vendor documentation, release notes or sponsored study. Language: "vendor states".
D	Demo, announcement or unverified secondary report. Language: "early signal, not verified".

2 · Verified outcome — what actually happened

The vendor's claim is checked against outcomes FieldNote has tracked across real pilots. The gap between claim and verified reality is itself the intelligence — and the proprietary asset a summary can't reproduce.

3 · Fit to your business

Does it address a stated priority, and are the conditions where it works present at your company? A strong average outcome with poor fit is still the wrong bet.

4 · Complexity & risk

Implementation effort, downside exposure and reversibility.

The decision rule

ADOPT	Strong evidence (A/B) + consistent positive verified outcome + good fit + low downside.
PILOT	Positive but variable outcome, or strong fit on a high-effort response — prove it in your context against a control before rollout.
INVESTIGATE	Real potential on vendor-grade (C) evidence — get methodology and references, then a small controlled test.
WATCH	Weak evidence or a negative track record — do not act; the downside outweighs the upside.

Note: pilot counts and verified figures in this sample dossier are illustrative. In production they are drawn from FieldNote's tracked-outcomes ledger, which accrues with every customer pilot.

SSP RELEASE NOTES · 19 SEP 2026

SSP releases automated floor-price optimization

Recommend: Investigate | Evidence C | Yield mgmt | Ad operations

Why Investigate: Real but modest upside (+7%, not the 20–30% claimed) on vendor-only Grade-C evidence, with 4 of 34 rolling back → don't adopt blind. Get the methodology and references, then run a controlled pilot.

CLAIM → VERIFIED

~~SSP markets "20–30% RPM uplift"~~ → **+7% median across 34 tracked pilots; 9 saw <2%; 4 rolled back**

WHAT HAPPENED	Sets floor prices and allocates impressions automatically — could lift RPM without manual trafficking.
TRACK RECORD	Uplift is real but far below the pitch, and concentrated in publishers with high remnant volume; below that it isn't worth the volatility. Best fit: static floors and high remnant volume.
COMPANY RELEVANCE	Your yield team sets floors by hand across 3 SSPs — this targets exactly that manual effort.
REQUIREMENTS	Auction-level data · experiment design · SSP access · revenue guardrails.
KEY RISKS	Revenue volatility · opaque logic · single-SSP dependency.
SUCCESS MEASURES	RPM · fill rate · bid density · latency · net revenue — vs a control.
EVIDENCE & SOURCES	SSP release notes + 2 vendor case studies (unverified).

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Request the optimization methodology and 2–3 comparable references; if credible, run a bounded pilot on remnant inventory against a control before any wider trust.